

AFRICA MARKET LANDSCAPE

How different are these four African markets in terms of scale, economic context and crypto presence?

MARKETS ANALYZED

- Ghana
- Kenya
- Nigeria
- South Africa

LARGEST MARKET

Sources: World Bank

238M

Nigeria · Population · 2025

SMALLEST MARKET

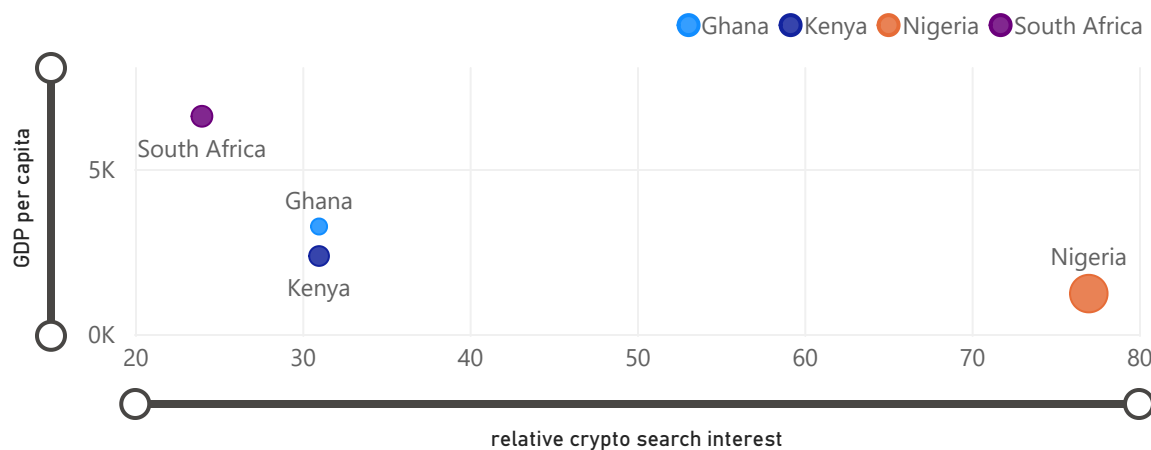
Sources : World Bank

35M

Ghana · Population · 2025

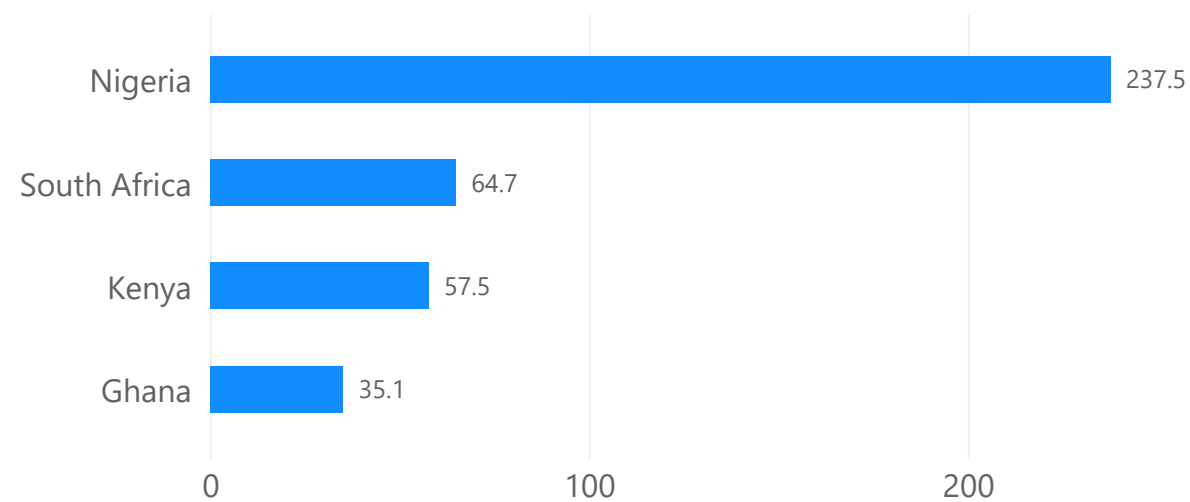
CRYPTO INTEREST ACROSS MARKET PROFILES

Sources : Google Trends · Relative search interest...



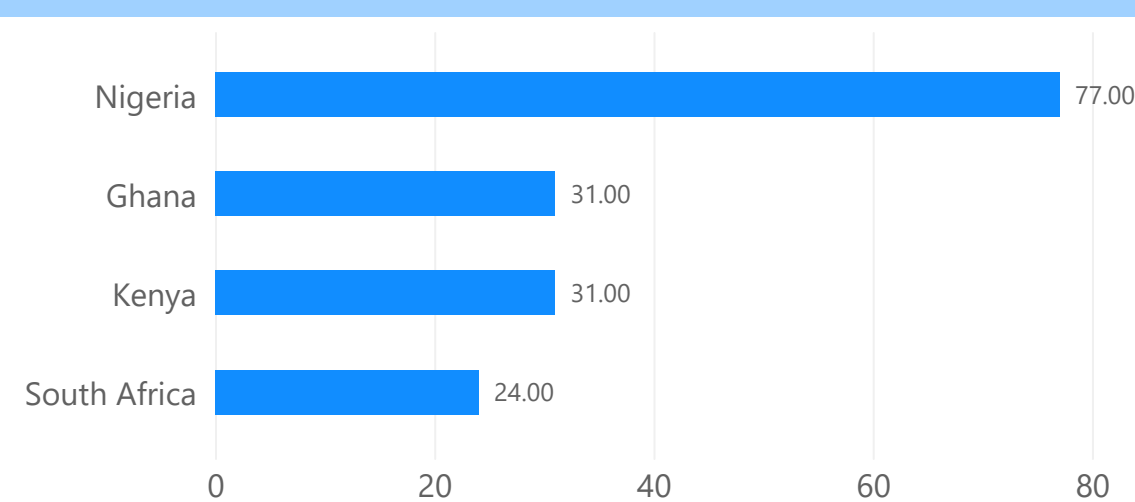
MARKET SCALE

Sources : World Bank · Population · 2025



CRYPTO SEARCH INTEREST

Sources : Google Trends · Relative search interest...



KEY INSIGHTS

1. Nigeria combines scale with strong crypto signals

237.5M people and **77 search interest** — 1.9* the four-market average — give Nigeria the strongest combination of market scale and observed crypto interest in this comparison.

2. Crypto interest doesn't simply follow economic strength

South Africa has the **highest GDP per capita (\$6,598)** and **highest internet penetration (78.4%)**, yet records the **lowest crypto search interest (24)**.

3. Similar interest can hide different market conditions

Ghana and Kenya both record **31 search interest**, but their Chainalysis adoption positions are **#46 and #28 globally** respectively.

CRYPTO INTEREST VS ADOPTION

Does consumer interest in crypto correspond with stronger adoption across these four markets?

AVERAGE SEARCH INTEREST

Sources: Google Trends · Relative search index

40.8

Four Markets · 2025

AVERAGE ADOPTION POSITION

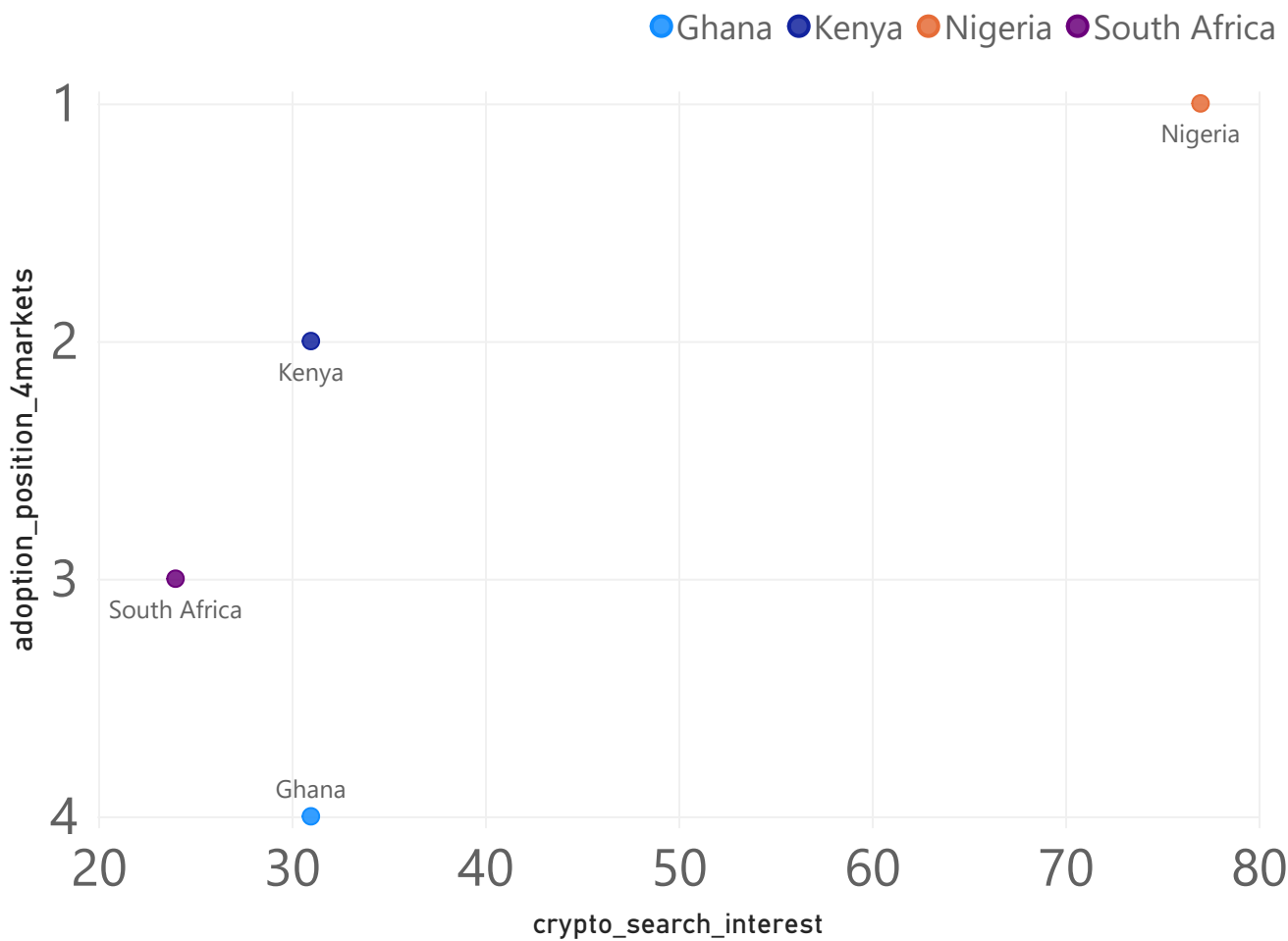
Sources: Chainalysis · Global Crypto Adoption Index

2.5

Four markets · 2024

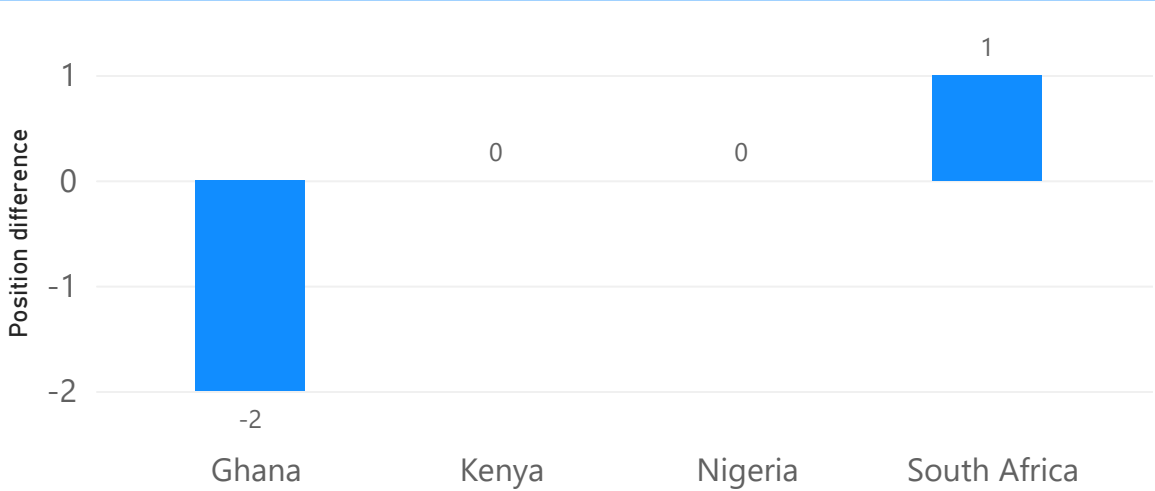
INTEREST VS ADOPTION

Sources : Google Trends 2025 · Chainalysis 2024



INTEREST VS. ADOPTION GAP

Position difference across the four markets



MARKET SIGNAL PROFILE

Interest, adoption position and divergence

country	Search Interest	Adoption position	Gap
Ghana	31	4	-2
Kenya	31	2	0
Nigeria	77	1	0
South Africa	24	3	1

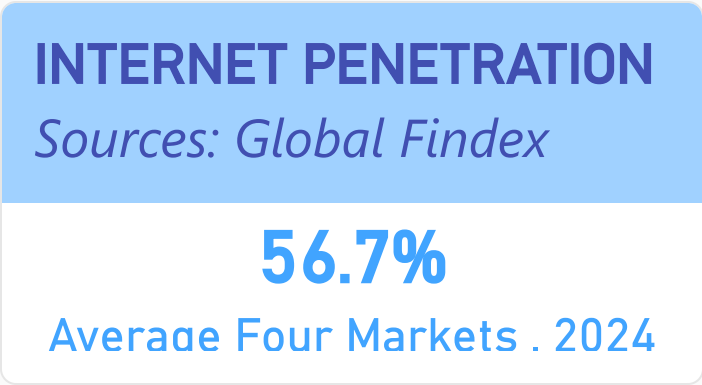
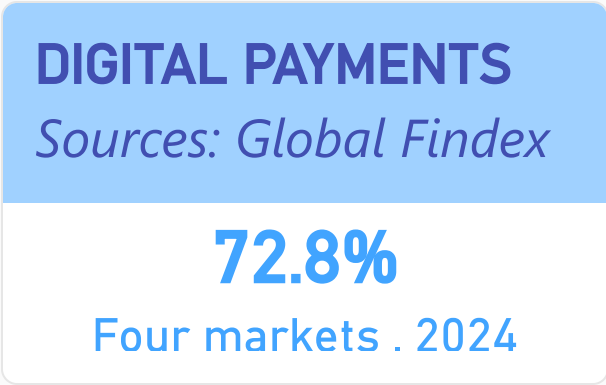
KEY INSIGHTS

- **Crypto interest does not consistently translate into stronger adoption**
The relationship between observed search interest and adoption position is **not uniform across the four markets**. Nigeria and Kenya show broadly aligned positions, while Ghana and South Africa show divergence. Nigeria ranks **#1 on adoption** with **77 search interest**, while Ghana has **31 search interest** but ranks **#46 globally**.
- **Similar demand signals can represent very different levels of market maturity**
Ghana and Kenya both record **31 search interest**, yet their adoption positions are materially different: **#46 vs #28 globally** — a **18-position difference** despite identical observed interest
- 1. **Strong adoption does not always come with strong observed search interest**
South Africa records the **lowest search interest (24)** — **21% below the four-market average of 40.8** — yet ranks **#30 globally** on Chainalysis adoption, ahead of Ghana at **#46**.

DIGITAL & FINANCIAL READINESS

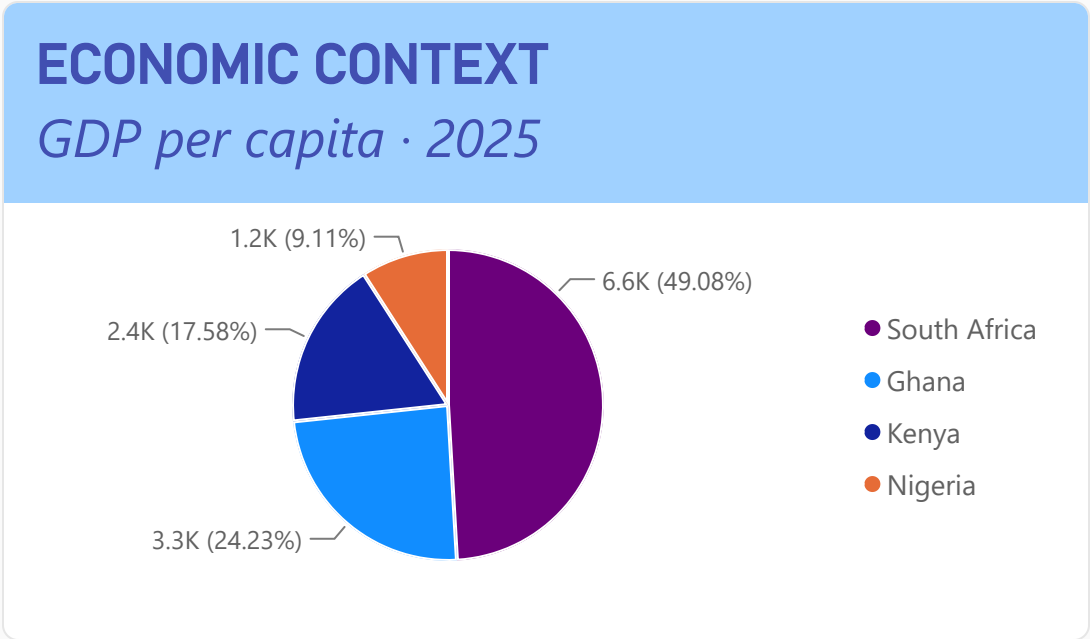
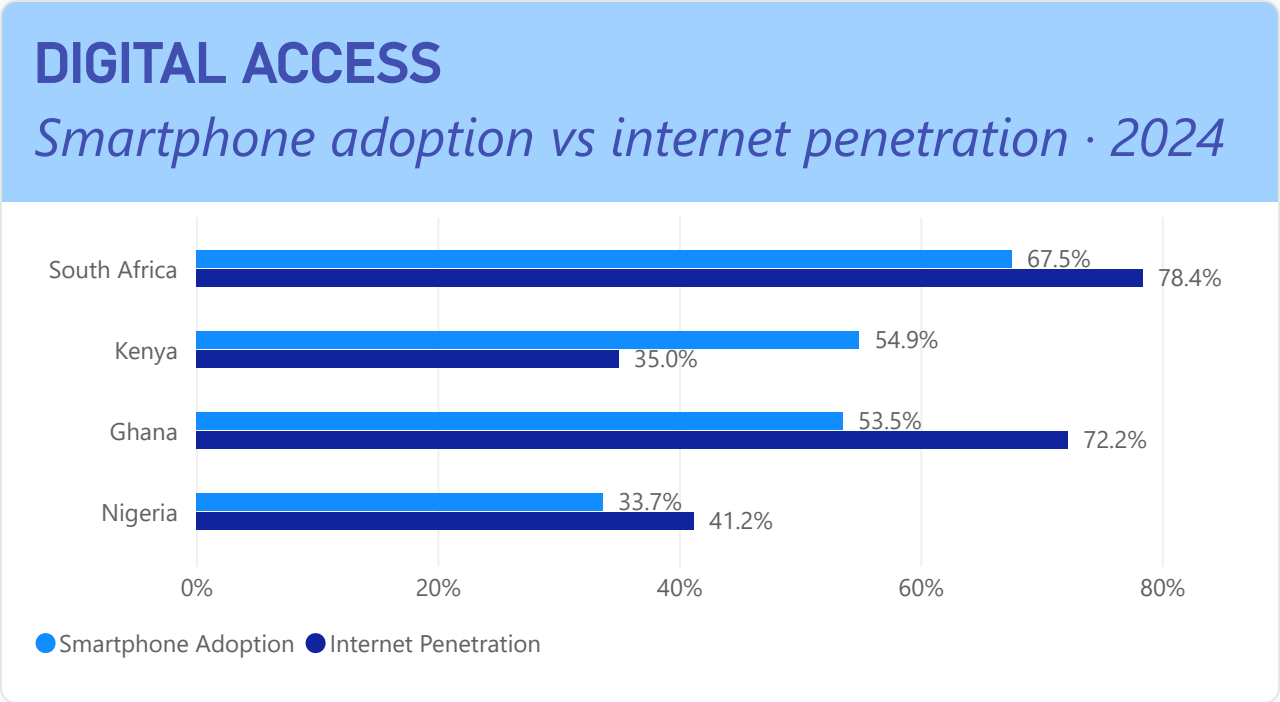
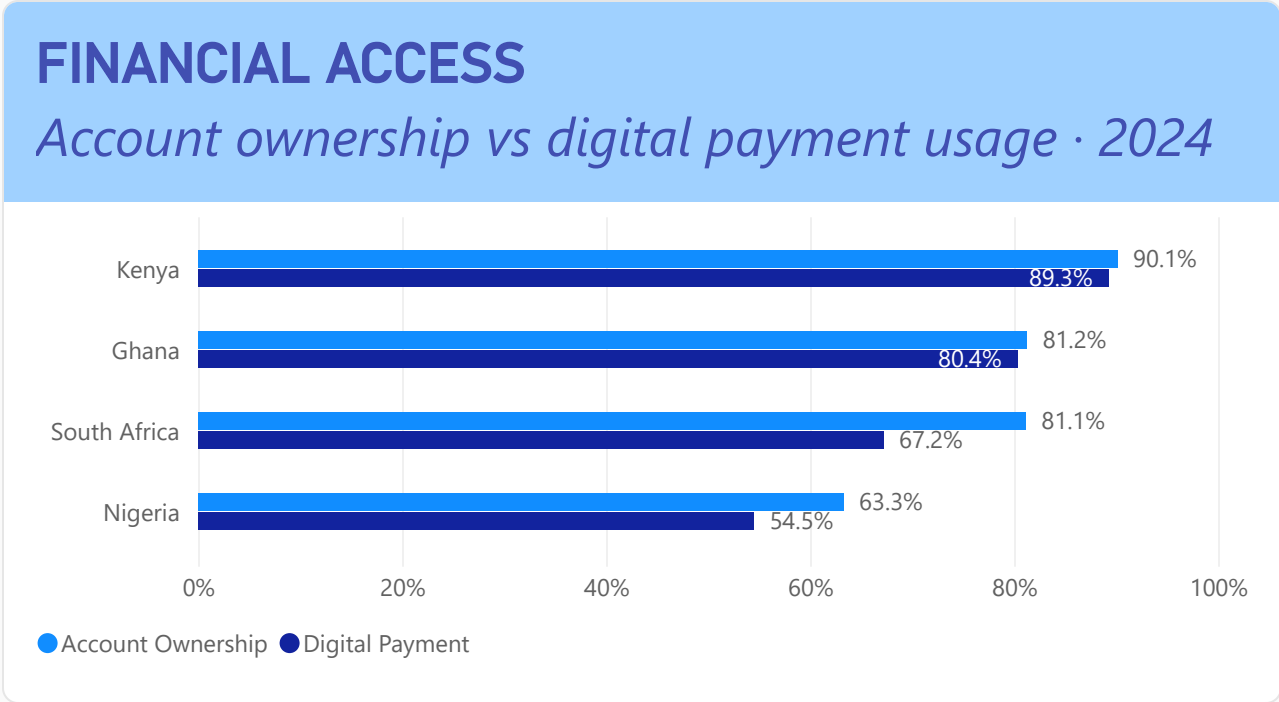
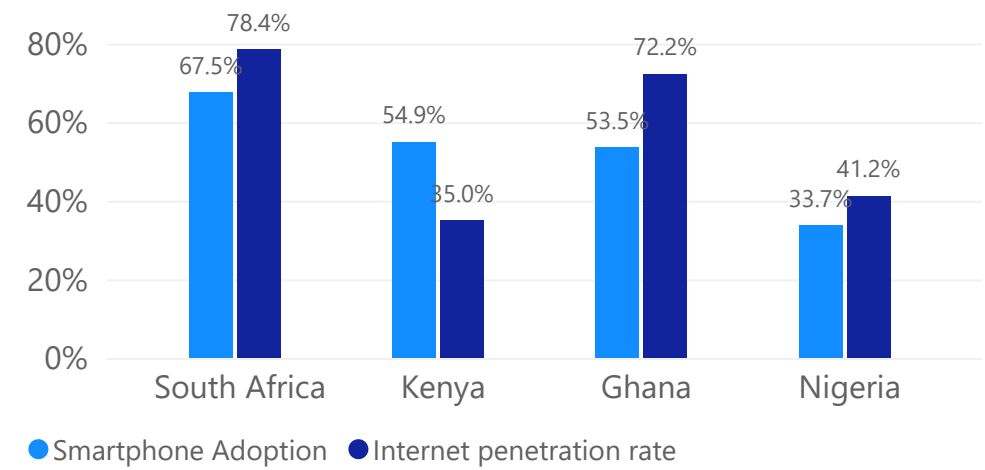
Financial Access → Digital Access → Economic Context → Business Implication

What underlying financial and digital conditions support participation across these markets?



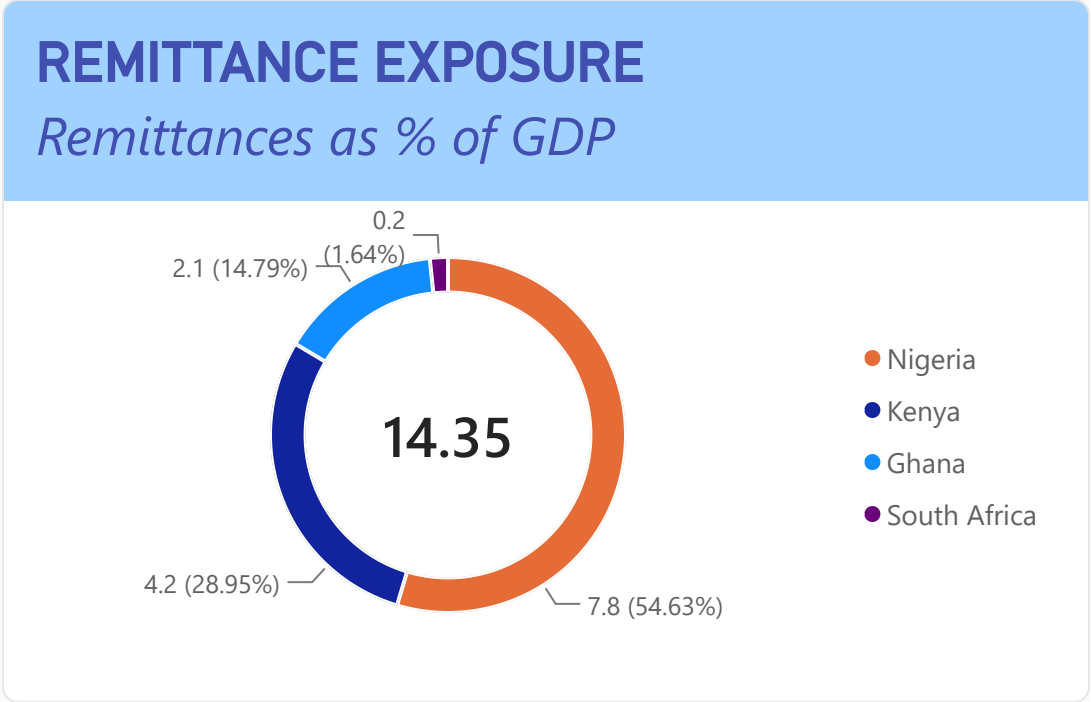
DIGITAL ACCESS

Smartphone adoption vs internet penetr...



KEY INSIGHTS

- Financial access and digital payment participation are strongest in some markets
Kenya records the highest account ownership (90.1%) and digital payment usage (89.3%), while Nigeria is materially lower at 63.3% and 54.5%, respectively.
- Digital connectivity does not move uniformly across markets
South Africa has the strongest combination of smartphone adoption (67.5%) and internet penetration (78.4%), while Kenya combines high financial participation with substantially lower internet penetration (35.0%).
- Market size and financial context differ materially
Nigeria has the largest population (237.5M) but the lowest GDP per capita among the four (\$1,224). South Africa has the highest GDP per capita (\$6,598) with a population of 64.7M.



FROM MARKET SIGNALS TO BUSINESS QUESTIONS

Four distinct market profiles - different questions to investigate, not a single market winner

MARKET PROFILE MATRIX

Crypto signal, financial access, digital connectivity and market scale

country	Search Interest	Adoption Position	Account Ownership	Internet penetration	Population (M)
Kenya	31.00	2.00	90.1%	35.0%	57.5
Ghana	31.00	4.00	81.2%	72.2%	35.1
South Africa	24.00	3.00	81.1%	78.4%	64.7
Nigeria	77.00	1.00	63.3%	41.2%	237.5

What the Data Suggests : Cross-market patterns that warrant further investigation

Crypto signals and market readiness do not move together

Nigeria has the strongest observed crypto signals among the four markets:

- **77** search interest
- **#1 adoption position** among the four
- **237.5M** population

Yet it has the lowest account ownership among the four at **63.3%** and the lowest smartphone adoption at **33.7%**.

Similar interest can represent different levels of market development

Evidence

Ghana and Kenya both record **31** search interest.

- Ghana → **#46 global adoption rank**
- Kenya → **#28 global adoption rank**
- Kenya → **90.1% account ownership**
- Ghana → **81.2% account ownership**

That's an **18-position difference** in global adoption despite identical observed search interest.

Digital readiness does not automatically translate into stronger crypto interest

Evidence

South Africa has:

- **78.4%** internet penetration
- **67.5%** smartphone adoption
- **\$6,598** GDP per capita

Yet its crypto search interest is **24**, the lowest among the four. Its adoption position is **#3 among the four**, ahead of Ghana at #4.

What the Data does not capture : Additional data needed for better conclusion

Market Demand :

Does observed crypto interest translate into actual exchange activity?

Growth Economics?

Can user interest translate into sustainable growth?

Competitive & Market Conditions

What external factors could materially change the opportunity?

The current analysis is useful for market screening and hypothesis generation. It is not sufficient on its own to determine market-entry priority.